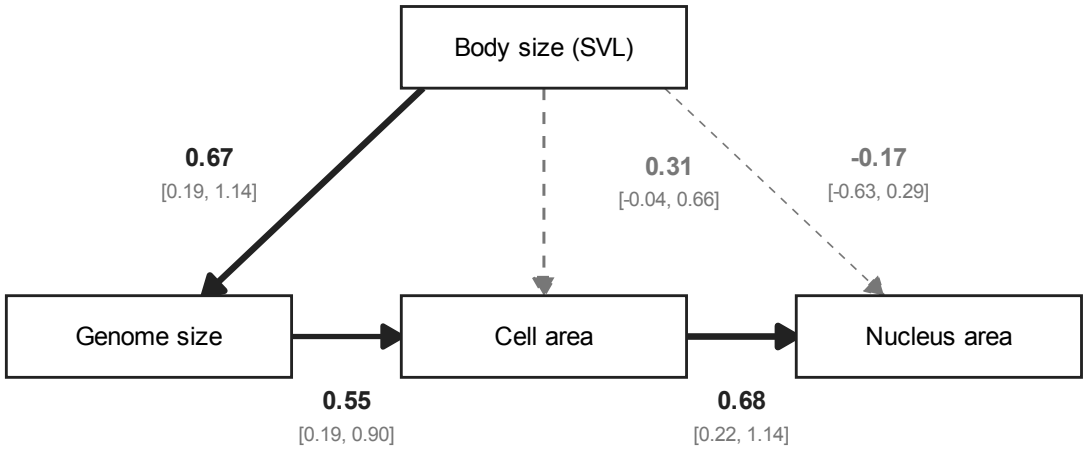
a

SVL-adjusted cell-bridge hypothesis

Highest-ranked of four candidates; n = 24; weight = 0.944; global-fit P = 0.850

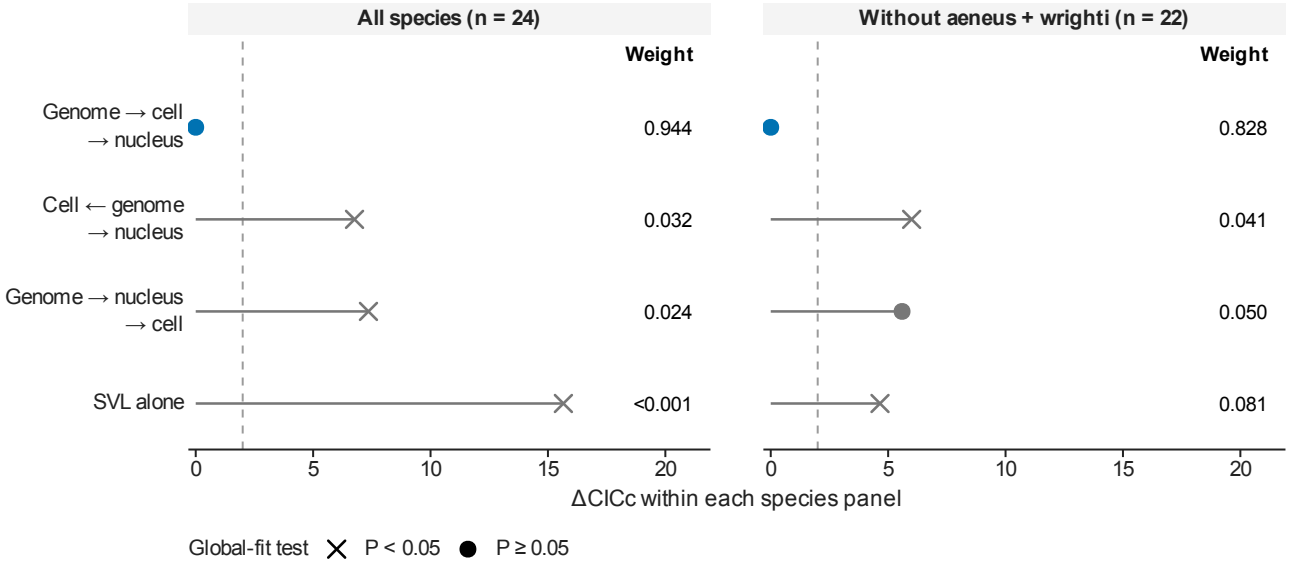


Full-panel standardized coefficients [95% t intervals]; widths scale with |coefficient|.
Gray dashed arrows: interval includes zero. Arrow directions are specified hypotheses.

b

Support among four SVL-adjusted hypotheses

Every candidate includes SVL → genome size, cell area and nucleus area.

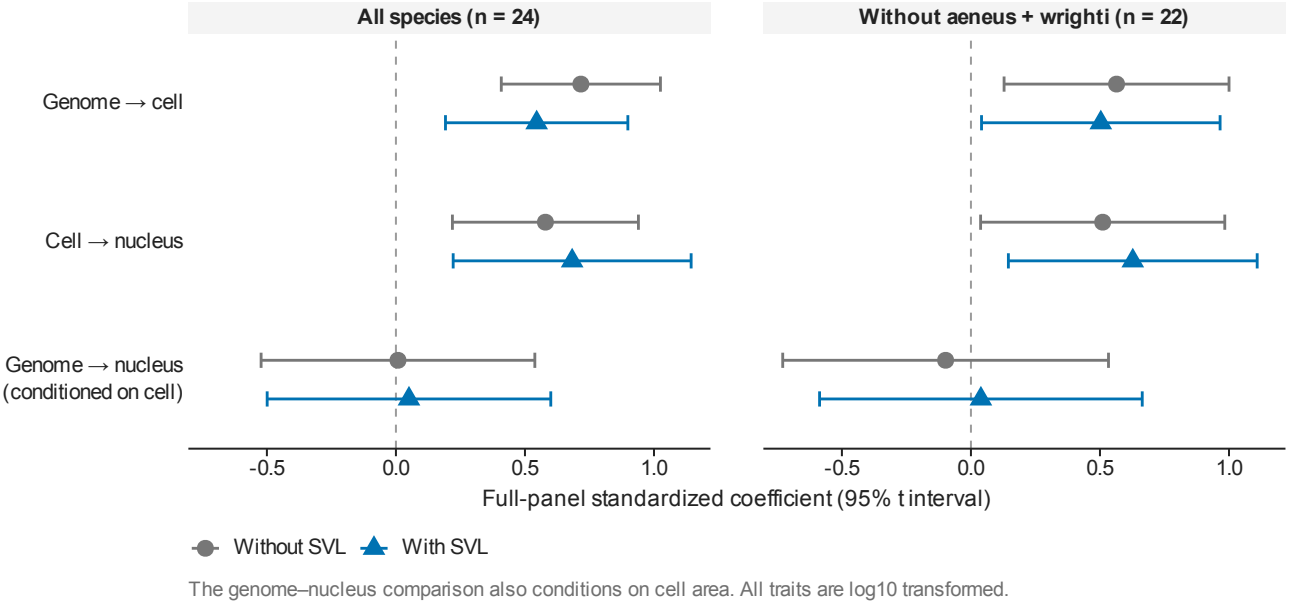


Dashed line: ΔCICc = 2. Weights compare only these four candidates within each panel.
Exclusion is a sensitivity analysis; body size and development mode differ together.

c

Do cellular associations persist after SVL adjustment?

Same species and response variables in each within-panel comparison.



The genome–nucleus comparison also conditions on cell area. All traits are log10 transformed.
The 22-species coefficients retain the means and SDs of the full 24-species panel.